



11.5. STRESS MANAGEMENT AND STRESS REDUCTION TECHNIQUES

- Breathing exercises
- Progressive relaxation
- Visualisation - (visualise yourself on the beach or some other enjoyable place)
- Listen to music and / or relaxation tapes (you can buy them or record your own)
- Refute irrational ideas (is what you just told yourself really true?)
- Various spiritual or religious practices (prayer, reflection, meditation, contemplation)
- Practice gratitude (and try to forgive)
- Avoid people and situation(s) that causes stress (to the extent possible). Pare down your to-do list
- Call a good friend or find other ways to connect with others (share your feelings)
- Engage in realistic goal setting and time management. Practice assertiveness and boundary setting (learn to say No). Stop trying to control the uncontrollable.
- Keep your sense of humour
- Practice good nutrition - eating a healthy diet makes us better prepared to cope with stress. Get enough sleep.
- Sweat the stress out through exercise (take a run or walk, stretch, do yoga, lift weights)
- HeartMath Techniques (www.Heartmath.org)
- Make time for fun and relaxation. Take a hot bath, get a massage, play with a pet, work in your garden, curl up with a good book, write in your journal, spend time in nature. Nurturing yourself is a necessity, not a luxury - only you can take care of yourself - no one else can do this for you.
- Other ideas?